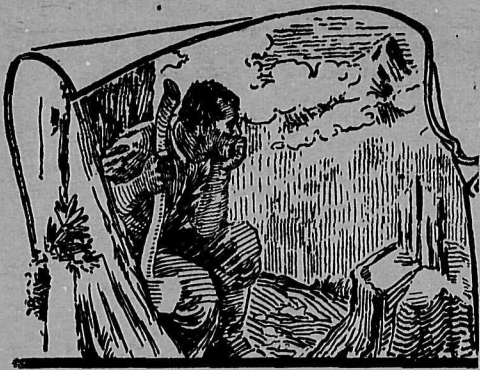
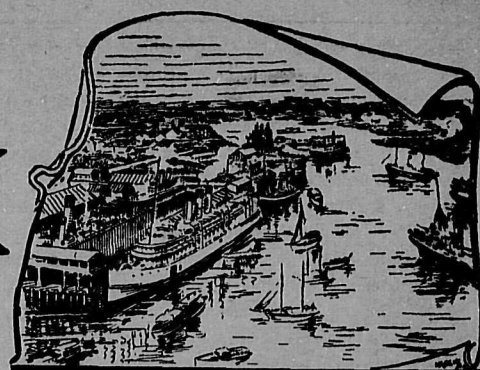




The Week

A British Columbia Newspaper and Review



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Canada's Jubilee

DOMINION DAY 1867 was the birthday of a new nation, and a true poet has precised Canada's relation to the Mother Country and to the world in a single stanza:—

*A Nation spoke to a Nation
A Throne sent word to a Throne;
"Daughter am I in my mother's house,—
But mistress in my own;
The doors are mine to open,
As the doors are mine to close,
And I abide in my mother's house,"
Said our Lady of the Snows.*

The lapse of fifty years has enabled the Canadian people to verify this poetic prophecy, and to set a new value upon the labors of the Fathers of Confederation. The Canadian Constitution is an undying monument to the constructive statesmanship of those men of vision and judgment who organized this great Dominion, but it is also a lasting tribute to the legislators and administrators who for years before fought to establish the principles of liberty, justice and equality in the new Britain beyond the sea. The work of the Fathers would not have been possible then and perhaps never, had we not had representatives of the Home Land and true men of our own who had dreams of another great British Commonwealth in the northern half of America. Such Governors as Durham, Sydenham, Metcalfe and Elgin, with the true British instinct, royal democrats, men of poise, vision and common sense, with daring and firmness, were the guiding influences in the young Canada yet to be. These Governors with unique training and experience, sought to firmly root in the new land the principles of responsible government, and British connection. They were ably supported by such statesmen as Baldwin, La Fontaine and Hincks. To the memory of these men stand institutions and legislation of lasting benefit to the Canadian people. Rarely, if ever, do we have the name of Robert Baldwin connected with Toronto University and with our Canadian municipal system, yet he was the founder of both. Conceived as the apex and crown of a comprehensive scheme of education as broad as Canada, the University of Toronto has more than met the hopes of its founder. The benevolence of both political parties to this institution witnesses and justifies the wisdom of this man of vision. The generations of Toronto graduates should hold in high esteem the name of Robert Baldwin who made possible the seat of learning they are so proud to name their *alma mater*. Home Rule for every city, county, township and village in Canada was another measure for which Baldwin deserves no little praise. Municipal government seems commonplace to us today, yet the lack of it is a serious grievance in many old centres, and we must not fail to appreciate this great privilege we enjoy. The secularization of the Clergy Reserves, the abolition of Seigneurial Tenure in Quebec, the Reciprocity Treaty of 1854, the Canal System are all of national importance and were all wisely dealt with before the direct struggle for the greater union took place. But though foundations were laid in Canada and in the Provinces by the Sea, yet many obstacles stood in the way. Many difficulties had to be overcome, great obstacles removed, a great amount of education carried on, before any union of the British American Provinces could be effected. Though many of the French looked to the day when they should have an independent republic on the banks of the St. Lawrence; though Scottish, Irish and English immigrants, with allegiance divided with their hearts still in the cabins and homes they left across the sea, were not yet wedded to the land of their adoption and though the settlers from the United States brought up on the Declaration of Independence and Fourth of July oratory were crying out for annexation, there was one solid kernel for British connection and for the establishment of a British Commonwealth in America—that kernel was made up of the United Empire Loyalists. These people suffered loss, distress and ignominy for their love of the home land and were not going to yield it lightly. From them came the men that had the vision and that led the way. Then the Provinces were very much isolated—four Provinces by the sea, Quebec and Ontario farther inland, British Columbia by the Pacific, and a great stretch of country controlled by the Hudson Bay Company lying between each of those British centres was developing slowly without any regard for another centre. Transportation was exceedingly slow, difficult and costly. There were no great questions to fan the fires of patriotism in any one of the Provinces. When federation was mentioned, doubts were cast upon the project. Is it not a wonder the principle did not die? The marvel is not that federation lagged, but that men with vision and courage, forced to view these depressing conditions at close range, were able to keep the idea alive. A day of loftier ideas, and greater issues was about to dawn. The ablest politicians had been prone to wrangle like washerwomen over a tub. Local jealousies, the factious spirit, personal and party prejudice flourished apace. Measures of importance were unheeded or could not be passed. Goldwin Smith asserted that the real parent of Confederation was Deadlock. But the causes lay far deeper than in the breakdown of party government in Canada. Events of profound significance were about to change the atmosphere and strike the imagination of men. The first factor in the national awakening was the call of the great western domain. British Americans began to realize they were heirs to a rich and noble possession. It was a vision calculated to rouse the adventurous spirit of the British race in colonizing and in developing vast and unknown lands. Though the desire for expansion, dominion and commerce fired the minds of men, another event stirred their hearts and sentiments. The young

Prince of Wales visited Canada as the representative of our beloved Queen Victoria. The visit evoked feelings, revived memories and revealed the intensity of attachment to the traditions and institutions of the home land. But of all the influences and events that startled the people of the Provinces, the Civil War in the United States exerted the most immediate influence. The thoughts of war between Great Britain and the United States, with Canada as the battleground, forced the thinking of Canadian statesmen. Encouragement came from the Imperial authorities. Events at home brought about the Quebec and Charlottetown conventions, and the basis of federation was arranged. John A. Macdonald, George Brown, A. T. Galt, Charles Tupper, George Cartier, S. L. Tilley, D'Arcy McGee, were the leading figures in nation-building. Each had strong convictions and fixed ideas, but each was willing to sacrifice and compromise for the good of the nation. Men who had not spoken to each other for ten years forgot the past and buried their differences, and politicians who fought each other in local arenas, sat together in the first Canadian Cabinet. What a glorious example to future generations!

The fifty years that has elapsed has shown the wisdom of the fathers, and has thrown into bold relief the greatness of their undertaking. On this golden jubilee we can look back over the national period and see to what extent we have attained the ideals of 1867. A threefold purpose inspired the founders. Their first duty was to evolve a workable plan of government. Experience shows how they succeeded. The British North America Act, the Constitution of Canada, always on trial, tested severely, is firmly rooted in the national mind. The structure stands a monument to those who erected, and the admiration of many self-governing states. The second task was the most difficult—the unification of the Provinces was no light matter. What were Dominion rights and what were Provincial was sometimes a matter of doubt. Time enabled the Governments to solve these problems. In due time the Nova Scotian came to regard himself as a Canadian, and a British Columbian had ceased to look upon the man from the East as a North American Chinaman. We are all Canadians developing a community of interest. To preserve the Imperial tie was the third great object. Wise Governors had pretty well fixed that principle in the minds of the people. But there were fears. A few still cherished the thought of annexation; others had in mind another independent nation in North America: but the faith of the Fathers that it was possible to have a self-governing nation, still maintaining fidelity to the Crown has been realized. We have grown, we are not perfect, but we are trying to perpetuate the traditions of freedom and toleration handed on to us to work out the ideals of pure government and respect for law. We are trying to develop a nation within a nation that shall have respect for righteousness, justice and equality. May the God of our Fathers bless our efforts.

A Local Jubilee

IT is pleasant to record an event too seldom found amongst our people in the West. Mr. and Mrs. David Spencer celebrated just as we were going to press last week, the fiftieth anniversary of their wedding. Blessed with a numerous family—thirteen in all—who in turn have developed the sterling characteristics of their parents, and with still more numerous scions of the third generation, they assembled in an old-fashioned family gathering at the parental home on Moss Street. A kindly providence has smiled upon their business undertakings, and placed the worthy couple beyond anxiety and worldly care. They have borne worthily their share in church activities, in benevolent and philanthropic enterprises, and their names are deeply engraved upon the civic life of Victoria. Sons and daughters and sons-in-law have stood by the gradual development of their mercantile pursuits and have in later years assumed the responsibilities and labors of their parents. Time has dealt most-graciously with Mr. and Mrs. Spencer, and mellowed their many noble qualities of disposition and life, and it is with the sincerest of wishes that THE WEEK hopes for them many years of wedded union yet, surrounded by those whom they have loved and who reciprocate their affection. To all must come—soon or late—the severing of ties that have long been welded, but every friend of the kindly pair will hope that the Grim Reaper will stay his hand a longer period yet, and that both may enjoy in the retirement of their beautiful home an honorable and well-earned rest: "Until the day break and the shadows flee away."

Sir Spud

THE POTATO has come to its own again. Once upon a time it was spurned as being too lowly for aristocratic and lordly stomachs to feast upon and vegetables more expensive were placed on the patrician table. Today the humble potato reigns supreme. Fried, boiled, baked or steamed; it has become an object of solicitude and housewives with anxiety depicted on their faces ask: Where can we buy it, and will our bank credits stand the strain? More than that, the humble potato has displaced the lawn, the golf course and the tennis court. The vacant lot is a misnomer, it has become a "potato patch." Poor jokes have been made about the tuber; poetry—not poetry but rhyming rubbish has been written; markets have been scoured to get it; stock exchange jobbers have dealt "short and long" in it, and questions in Parliament have been asked about it. It has risen from obscurity and indifference to a chief place in our national economies. City Fathers, paterfamilias, and dainty mesdames have been seen plying the hoe, spade or rake trying to stimulate production, and less unfriendly remarks have been directed towards the meteorologist on Gonzales Hill because of copious showers this season than ever before in his official career. Discussions as to the method of planting, the kind of seed, the fertilizers required, the probable yield

have made life joyous and awakened a new vista of national life. It is stated that one of our English kings was once so charmed with the succulence and quality of a loin of beef that he promptly knighted it and it became with its heirs and successors, Sir Loin forever and aye. Without any Royal Warrant THE WEEK ventures to issue its journalistic warrant to all and sundry, and raise the status of the tuber to a higher rank—the rank of knighthood. Rise up: rise up in your millions: Sir Spud.

Spain and Royalty

THE dispatches from Spain are very disquieting. It would almost seem as if the ancient monarchies are crumbling, and the old regimes are preparing to pass away. The Romanoffs have stepped off the plane of Russian life and are probably meditating upon the past glories of their race. Constantine of Greece has not received the heartiest of welcome from the Swiss people, and the Sultan of Turkey did not, when he was bowed out of his palace, feel exactly as if a bed of roses awaited him. The "bloody House of Hapsburg," as Kossuth, the great Hungarian patriot, designated the Austrian Imperial family, has not built itself upon the assured rock of their people's affection and esteem, nor has the House of Hohenzollern a reserve power of confidence and loyalty to draw upon in the length and breadth of Germany. Whether the Royal House of Spain, which has been strengthened by alliance with the Royalty of Britain, can survive the Revolutionary movement is, at time of writing, a matter of conjecture. The news received from that country at present is so meagre that it is difficult to draw accurate conclusions. The whole system of monarchy, absolute or even limited, appears to be in the melting pot, and the war-furnace seems to be fusing and fashioning it afresh. Unrest, disquiet, faction, excitement and uprisings are all in the air and that throne is happy indeed in these days that is "broad-based upon the people's will." Whether for good or ill, the great world-tragedy is testing out the soul of things. Shams, superfluities, hypocrisies, ceremonials, and meaningless offices are being tried in the crucible. The x-ray of scorching public criticism is being applied to all and sundry, and there is no person too exalted, no rank too great, no office too sacred but what must pass through the fire. The British Royal House rests securely in the judgment, affection and consideration of the British people in all lands where its sceptre sways, because from the days of Victoria the Good until King George V was acclaimed King and Emperor, each occupant of the throne has always lent an attentive ear to the cry of the oppressed, the wail of suffering or the need of the poor. The blue blood of Spain may, like others of its ilk, pass away into oblivion, but the democracy of the British Empire will join hands with the proudest of its aristocracy in maintaining and conserving the British Royal House so long as it preserves unbroken its traditions of freedom, justice and truth. Singularly enough, with the perversity of Orientalism, the Chinese people appear to have reverted back again to imperialism. The President has been "induced" to vacate, and a youthful Emperor has mounted the Imperial throne. If any of the readers of THE WEEK is admitted to the presence of His August Majesty, we would suggest that he cause to be printed on his visiting card for presentation the words of a world-renowned English poet: "Uneasy lies the head that wears a crown."

Sir Arthur Currie

WHO would have thought it? A school-teacher: a business man: taking up soldiering more as a pastime at the first, rather than as a pursuit, and now called to a supreme command in the militant forces of Canada "somewhere in France." Such are the rapid changes wrought by war, the lightning artist on the world's canvas. Sir Arthur has had his critics, even amongst those who rejoice in his success, and many an open shrug of the shoulders, or a concealed sneer told of doubt engendered, but such critics would be mean indeed if they would withhold from one who has served faithfully and well his meed of praise, or who would not congratulate when well-deserved honors have been accorded to him by his Gracious Sovereign. The responsibility that Victoria's foremost soldier has borne might well have daunted the stoutest heart and broken the strongest will. It is fitting that his adopted city should celebrate his triumph and the recognition of his devotion and ability. Congratulations: Sir Arthur!

The B. C. Electric Company

VICTORIANS will be glad to learn that the B. C. Electric Company has offered to transfer its holdings in British Columbia to either the Provincial Government or the municipalities of Vancouver and Victoria, on terms which appear to offer a basis for negotiation. It is, of course, too soon to pronounce definitely in favor of the proposals. Until the exact details of the offer are made public it would be premature to come to any decision but the municipal authorities are hopeful that the negotiations will result in the municipalization of the transportation, lighting and power services now in the hands of the B. C. Electric Company. It is understood that the company is willing to accept Government bonds for its power plants at Lake Buntzen and Jordan River, and Municipal bonds for its physical assets within the municipal boundaries. In both cases the properties are to be valued by neutral parties and the agreement ratified by the shareholders of the company on the one hand and the electors on the other. The present Mayor and Council of Victoria may be trusted to carefully safeguard the interests of the city and to recommend the adoption of the by-law only after giving the matter their most thorough attention. Some citizens are opposed to the purchase of the company's holdings on the grounds that the street car service

does not pay and that it is impossible to devise any system whereby it can be made to pay. This attitude appears to be a needlessly pessimistic one. The population of the city is low just now because of the absence of the overseas troops and their families, but with the return of peace there will be an influx of population which will astonish even the optimists. With a population of 50,000-60,000 the cars will again operate at a profit and the co-ordination of public utility services under popular control will result in a great impetus to the industries of B. C. It would seem eminently desirable to try to secure the gas undertaking at the same time and thus put Victoria in the forefront of cities which own and operate their own utilities. THE WEEK sincerely hopes that the negotiations may be brought to a satisfactory conclusion and that a deal advantageous to both parties may be consummated. If both sides enter the conference sincerely anxious to do justice to all, we have no doubt of what the result will be.

Unfair to Local Trades

THERE has been a little bit of what would appear to be a sharp practice on the part of somebody in connection with the summer school at present being held in Victoria. From what we can gather, the facts seem to be as follows: The summer school is held under the Government Department of Education. Teachers from all over the Province are invited, and between three and four hundred are in attendance. Now the students attending summer school happen to require certain books and also stationery. In the ordinary course the students would purchase these necessities from the ordinary book-sellers' stores in town. In this case, however, it appears to have appealed to some enterprising individual or individuals that there was here a fine chance to make a little profit on the side. Result, one of the high school rooms is occupied as a kind of book store, at which the teachers can purchase books and stationery. To make things perfectly agreeable and pleasant, a teacher takes charge of the sales. As far as can be gathered, one particular book store in town has secured the privilege of doing this trade to the exclusion of all other booksellers and stationery warehouses in the city, and so we have this state of affairs: part of a public building is handed over to a local storekeeper in which to run his business, shutting out all competitors. Such an arrangement may be a great convenience to students attending the summer school, but at the same time it works not a little hardship on other booksellers who are bound to suffer because they had laid in special supplies for the occasion. The Fernwood Drug Store will, perhaps, be the hardest hit of all and the proprietor has just cause for grievance since he went to the trouble of procuring special supplies in anticipation of the summer school trade. What is perhaps the strangest thing of all in connection with this little piece of business is that the Department of Education, under Dr. Robinson, knew nothing about it; nor the School Board, nor anybody else in a position of sufficient authority to empower his entering into such transactions. It would be interesting to know just what lies at the bottom of the arrangement and it would be particularly interesting to know what is being done with the profits made on the sales: how much is being paid for the use of the room; and who is responsible for the entire undertaking.

THE MUSINGS OF AN ASSEMBLY COMMISSIONER

What a kaleidoscope is Canada! The Grand Trunk Pacific Railway served as guide and friend, mercifully permitting one to do one's own philosophizing. A sea trip of two days amid rugged mountainous islands, wooded to the water's edge, with an occasional evidence of human habitation, hardly to be excelled by a cruise in the fjords of Norway, lands one in Prince Rupert whence the transcontinental journey begins. Thence the unsurpassed beauty of the Skeena, the agricultural and grazing possibilities of the Bulkley and Nechaco Valleys, with the lumbering opportunities of these and the Upper Fraser, and the incalculable water power everywhere at hand, set one wondering about the people who some day will call that vast northern region "home."

Whence will they come? Why will they come? What will they bring with them in hand, in head and in heart to make the greater British Columbia of the future? What conditions, social, religious and political will they find or create? What conditions have we made to attract the best into our virgin heritage? One is somewhat surprised at the sparseness of population, and cannot but wonder whether the greatest wisdom has been exercised in seeking to bring to the notice of the landless man these vast and inviting stretches of manless land.

Most wise has been the policy of the Governments of B. C. and of Alberta in reserving as play grounds for the people for all time the great areas known as Mount Robson and Jasper Parks. The glimpse that one gets of Mt. Robson's cloud wreathed brow justifies the use of all the tourist-guide book adjectives.

What a magnificent stretch of prairie land is traversed by the G. T. P. through Alberta and Saskatchewan! What substantial towns arrest the flying trains, and what comfortable homesteads dot the plain—Saskatoon, that city of wealth and culture, of ambition and vain regret—how different today from those deserted buildings of a temperance colony and the one small shack which supplied lunch to the crew and passengers of the two trains a week that arrived over the rails from Regina to Prince Albert in those days so well remembered by some of us who will not be called old! We are in the midst of great peace movements. Do we realize it? But there are things strange and curious in these days of ours. They would be funny if they were not so costly. At one point the G. T. P.

have been changed in character and in use; while miles upon miles of farm land have been annexed and built upon. A new city, yes, but the old mountain, the old river, and after all the old city, made new and great. Long may she thrive!

At the suggestion of the Editor I headed my sketch the "Musings of an Assembly Commissioner" and to justify that title, let me conclude with the resolution in which the undivided Presbyterian Church successfully passed the rock that threatened to wreck her and gave her new cause to sing "Praise God from whom all blessings flow":

1. That the Assembly express its sincere sympathy with the desire conveyed in many of the overtures to avoid disunion among the membership of our own Church, and, to this end, earnestly urge upon our people that debate and organized propaganda on either side be discontinued in the meantime, and that a spirit of prayer be cultivated.

2. That inasmuch as the resolution of the last Assembly sets forth that further action will not be taken until the second Assembly after the close of the war, to secure peace in the meantime, the Assembly urges that controversy on the matter of Organic Union be dropped by all parties; that no attempt be made at the present time to set forth in detail the action appropriate to a future period, but that the Church patiently await the new light which it may receive by Divine guidance through the growing experience of the people and the lessons of the war.

3. That the work of the Union Committee for this period be confined to the superintendence of such practical forms of co-operation as have been already authorized, and that the personnel of this committee be modified in order to secure the fullest approval for such co-operative requirements.

—W. L. C.

But Not If They Are About Herself

Miss Quizer: "Do you believe all the disagreeable things you read in the newspapers?"

Miss Buzbuz: "I do, if they're about people I know."

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

The Week invites letters from its readers on all subjects of public interest. Letters need not be signed by the writer but a nom de plume may be used for publication, and they must be accompanied in every case by the name and address of the writer as a guarantee of good faith. This will be treated by the Editor entirely in confidence. The Editor also reserves the right to withhold publication of any letter without having to give a reason for so doing.

Theatre Exits

Victoria, July 4, 1917.

Editor, The Week.
Sir.—Perhaps with our "fine eyes fixed" on the awful war we are unable to see much about us, but I always find it rather terrifying to come to an exit in a theatre and find it looked in some way or other.

I spoke to the Fire Chief about one which I found so, and was treated courteously, and the place was attended to promptly.

Last week, after the matinee of "Joan the Woman," I saw a lady try to leave at a side exit and saw that she found it barred or locked. The people were slowly filing out of a narrow middle exit. To my best belief there was not a man in sight, all women and children. The girl in charge walked out with the audience long before the end.

When we consider the Charite Bazaar, with its hundreds of dead, burned at three in the afternoon; and the Iroquois Theatre, with its hundreds burned by a fire which broke out during an evening performance, it seems as if we should take a little trouble to have the doors fully opened and the side exits never locked or barred until all the audience have left.

Even if money is spent for years, seemingly without necessity, for precaution, it is better than having some day a great loss of life.

(MRS.) J. WOODWARD.

The Jury System

To the Editor.
Your recent editorial on the collapse of the jury system in connection with the trials of the ex-Ministers in Manitoba, induces me to set out certain ideas which I have for some time entertained.

The causes which combined threaten our jury system are two-fold. There are the weaknesses which are inherent in the system itself. There are as well, certain factitious evils which strike at the very basis of the system. Of the former may be mentioned the lack of training in the average man to combine together separate parcels of information and to form clear logi-

cal judgments thereon. In the same class, may also be noted the susceptibility of the average man to the popular sentiment. He is also a fair mark for the emotional and sentimental and casuistic addresses of counsel. These and other minor defects arising in the very nature of the system are well known and need little elucidating.

Of those factitious evils which have affected the system, there are three prominent ones which occur to mind and which will be dealt with as mentioned.

The first of these arises in what might be termed partisanship and bias. The effects of partisanship are seen in the complete breakdown of the jury trial, as outlined in your editorial. But its effects were generally, if they were unnoticed, recognized prior to Mr. Hudson's announcement. Similarly we have a social and fraternal bias. In a certain case where the accusation was theft and the evidence seemed to point to guilt, jurymen told me afterwards that the accused was a "decent fellow" and that they didn't believe he would do that of which he was accused. In the same instance, assurances were given crown counsel, by leading members of a lodge to which accused belonged, that no influence would be exerted in his behalf on the grounds of such fraternity—while on the other hand evidence was to hand of this lodge's influence on the jury. One jurymen, after the case, remarked to me, "He's a — (naming his society). They'd never convict him with that jury."

In another instance where a man was accused of a serious offence against two young girls, and the evidence, while not so clear as in the former case, would have justified a conviction, a jurymen afterwards stated to me, "— (naming him) is not a bad fellow. We didn't want to convict him on the word of two girls we didn't know. He had too many friends on the jury." Incidentally, the most important evidence against the accused was the breakdown of his own defence at a most crucial point. But the jury was friendly.

Apparently the jury as at present in vogue, is liable to the whole gamut of social emotions to dissuade it from its duty.

Another evil which has grown up about the system is the influence of private convictions and opinions. In a case where murder was charged, the evidence was as nearly perfect in every detail of motive and circumstance as it well could be. A verdict of "guilty" was confidently expected. The jury found manslaughter. A jurymen subsequently stated that some of the jurymen didn't believe in capital punishment and that they held out for a verdict of manslaughter. He said "—, I don't believe in capital punishment and I wouldn't sentence any man to death were he guilty as hell. I don't think it's right!"

In like manner the jurymen, no matter what the offence charged, may well render a verdict, not according to the evidence but according to his own private opinions which might clash with the true verdict.

The third evil, and one by no means unimportant, is the inconvenience resulting to jurymen, and the consequent as well as the natural disinclination to serve. Everyone knows the artifices which a summonsed jurymen employs to escape service. He dislikes the thing. It is inconvenient. He will avoid his duty and the law, if possible. The jurymen becomes himself a potential law-breaker. And he doesn't care anyway. In a certain case, the circumstances of which I have forgotten, a jurymen told me that all the jurymen wished to get away. They hadn't the desire to spend time going into the merits so they would "just let the fellow off. It wasn't very serious anyway." Another case developed evidence which would justify either acquittal or conviction. The jurymen were in a hurry. They actually either "drew straws" or "tossed up," I've forgotten which, and the verdict was given on the result.

Running through all these insidious evils, there is one common tendency. It is toward indifference or deliberate disregard for the oath which the jurymen takes. The reasons for this development need not here be considered. Suffice it that the jurymen so little regards the sanctity of his oath, or its truth-compelling obligations, that where adherence to his oath clashes with his opinions, his feelings or his comfort or convenience, the oath is of little weight. It is true that such a state of matters does not exist throughout the whole operation of the jury system. But these are facts which are growing into the system and threatening its usefulness.

The remedy? The first and perhaps most obvious answer would be: Education! But education of a society takes time; and while we educate, the protection of our laws will be suspended. In the meantime, until education has accomplished a more per-

fect society, some means must be established of dealing with that part of our social life which falls now within the scope of the criminal jury.

There is in our society a class of men whose training and whose experience fits them to occupy competently the place to be vacated by the jury. Furthermore, we find the same men performing with great ability a similar function in respect of the civil side of our law. I refer to our lawyers. Experience has taught us that our judiciary, drawn from our lawyers, is performing its most difficult duties in a degree highly satisfactory. Even in our criminal courts, it is recognized that the judge is a competent judge of facts as well as of law. I refer to the "Speedy Trial." In jury cases we find the judge striving to act as justly and impartially as possible.

Why not, then, do away with an institution whose usefulness is threatened and in its place put a committee of judges, of whose integrity, uprightness and impartiality practice has assured us. To further guarantee and protect the rights of the accused and of the society, a Court of Criminal Appeal should also be established. It has always seemed anomalous that in matters affecting the liberty of the subject and the safety of the state, there should be no satisfactory means of appeal.

It may well be argued that the creation and operation of such committees and courts would largely increase the costs of administration of our criminal law. Granted! But if the law is deemed good and beneficial and essential for the continued existence of our society, no expense is too great to provide for the able and competent enforcement of that law—provided of course, always, that an equally able and competent means may not be found otherwise.

Finally then, the jury system is growing today unreliable and unsafe. Experience has shown us that in civil and in criminal matters, the lawyer has proven and is proving himself a fair and competent minister of the law and interpreter of fact. Let us, then, abolish the criminal jury, and substitute for it the judge, or for greater security a committee of judges, with a court of appeal. The expense is incidental, and society and the individual are protected and made safe.

AN ATTENDANT AT COURT.

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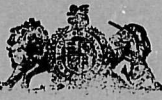
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PUBLIC WORKS OF CANADA
BRITISH COLUMBIA DREDGING FLEET
REPAIRS TO DREDGE "MASTODON"

Sealed tenders will be received by the undersigned, until 4 p.m. on Thursday, the 5th of July, for repairs and general overhaul of the Departmental Dredge "Mastodon" No. 306.

Each tender must be sent in a sealed envelope endorsed "Tender for Repairs to Dredge 'Mastodon'". Specifications can be seen at the office of A. F. Mitchell, Esq., Acting District Engineer, Victoria, B.C., and at the Office of C. C. Worsfold, Esq., District Engineer, New Westminster, B. C., and at the office of the undersigned, 614-18 Birks Building, Vancouver, B. C.

Each tender must be accompanied by an accepted cheque on a Chartered Bank, payable to the order of the Honourable the Minister of Public Works for the sum of \$800.00 (Eight Hundred Dollars), which will be forfeited if the person tendering declines to enter into a contract when called on to do so, or fail to complete the contract. If the tender is not accepted, the cheque will be returned. The Department does not bind itself to accept the lowest or any tender.

By order,
C. C. WORSFOLD,
Acting Superintendent of Dredges,
Department of Public Works,
Vancouver, B.C., June 19th, 1917.

Newspapers will not be paid for this advertisement if they insert it without authority from the Department.

LOCAL IMPROVEMENT NOTICE

Pursuant to Section 33 of the Local Improvement Act, public notice is hereby given that a Court of Revision will be held on Thursday, the 7th day of June, 1917, at the Court Chamber, City Hall, Victoria, B. C., at 3 p. m. for the hearing of complaints against the Special Assessment of lots abutting on the following work of local improvement, namely, grading and paving with a light asphaltic pavement Driveway between Fort Street and Leighton Road, and constructing curbs and boulevards on both sides of said street, also surface drainage, and necessary lateral connections to sewer, surface and water mains. The Special Assessment Roll in respect of the said work of local improvement will be kept open for inspection at the office of the City Clerk at the City Hall, Victoria, B.C., for at least ten days next before a day appointed for the sitting of the said Court of Revision herein advertised.

WELLINGTON J. DOWLER,
C. M. C.
City Clerk's Office,
Victoria, B. C.,
May 26, 1917.

NOTICE TO CREDITORS

IN THE MATTER of the Estate of Edgar Rayner, late of the City of Victoria, in the Province of British Columbia, deceased.

NOTICE is hereby given that all persons having any claims, or demands against the late Edgar Rayner, who died on or about the 28th day of March, 1917, at the City of Victoria, in the Province of British Columbia, are required to send by post prepaid, or to deliver to send by hand, to the undersigned, solicitors herein for Robert Hemington Swinerton, Executor under the will of the said Edgar Rayner, their names and addresses and full particulars in writing of their claim, and statements of their accounts, and the nature of the security, if any, held by them, duly verified by Statutory Declaration. And take notice that at expiration of one month from the date hereof, the said Robert Hemington Swinerton, will proceed to distribute the assets of the said deceased among the persons entitled thereto, having regard only to the claims of which he shall then have had notice, and that the said Robert Hemington Swinerton will not be liable for the said assets or any part thereof to any person or persons whose claim he shall not then have received notice of.

Dated at Victoria, B. C., this 19th day of May, 1917.
BARNARD, ROBERTSON,
HEISTERMAN & TAIT,
Tenth Floor, B. C. Permanent Loan Bldg., Victoria, B. C., Solicitors for the above named Executor.
May 19 June 9

OREGON & CALIFORNIA RAILROAD CO. GRANT LANDS

Title to same re-vested in United States by Act of Congress dated June 9, 1916. Two million three hundred thousand acres to be opened for homesteads and sale. Timber and Agricultural Lands. Containing some of the best land left in United States. Now is the opportunity time. Large map showing lands by sections and description of soil, climate, rainfall, elevations, etc., postpaid, One Dollar. Grant Lands Locating Co., Box 610, Portland, Oregon.



SYNOPSIS OF COAL MINING REGULATIONS

Coal mining rights of the Dominion in Manitoba, Saskatchewan and Alberta, the Yukon Territory, the Northwest Territories and in a portion of the Province of British Columbia, may be leased for a term of twenty-one years renewable for a further term of twenty-one years at an annual rental of \$1 an acre. Not more than 2,500 acres will be leased to one applicant.

Application for a lease must be made by the applicant in person to the Agent or Sub-Agent of the District in which the rights applied for are situated. In surveyed territory the land must be described by sections, or legal subdivisions of sections, and in unsurveyed territory the tract applied for shall be staked out by the applicant himself. Each application must be accompanied by a fee of \$5, which will be refunded if the rights applied for are not available, but not otherwise. A royalty shall be paid on the merchantable output of the mine at the rate of five cents per ton.

The person operating the mine shall furnish the Agent with sworn returns accounting for the full quantity of merchantable coal mined and pay the royalty thereon. If the coal mining rights are not being operated, such returns should be furnished at least once a year.

The lease will include the coal mining rights only.

For full information application should be made to the Secretary of the Department of the Interior, Ottawa, or to any Agent or Sub-Agent of Dominion Lands.

W. W. CORY,
Deputy Minister of the Interior.
N.B.—Unauthorized publication of this advertisement will not be paid for.
April 2nd.

"Would you call for help if I attempted to kiss you?" "Not unless you needed it."

At The Street Corner

BY THE LOUNGER

O' wa'd some power the giftie gie us,
Tae see ourselves as others see us.

A stroll round the public market on Saturday last brought reminiscences of the scenes at Somers Town, Covent Garden, and other well crowded Old Country markets. The market building was packed to capacity and only with much effort and the exercise of exemplary patience could the complete round of all the stalls be made. Doubtless the Red Cross auction sale was the principal attraction but nevertheless the stall holders were doing a rushing trade. At a similar market in the Old Land the stall holders would announce the prices of their wares at the top of their voices and acquaint purchasers with the prices of their goods. Despite the disadvantage of the noise, there is an undeniable gain attached to the announcement of the prices at which goods are offered for sale. It enables customers to find the stall which is accepting the most reasonable price and tends to prevent the exorbitant few from getting super-profits from the unwary. Last Saturday inquiry at the various stalls established the fact that articles of equal quality were being offered at widely differing prices. Some stalls were undoubtedly offering bargains whilst others were asking prices considerably higher than those obtaining in the ordinary stores. Several customers openly expressed disgust at their treatment but investigation disclosed that in every case these customers had bought at stalls which were asking more than the average prices, and that had all the stalls marked the prices of their goods the disgusted ones could have had better

treatment elsewhere. It would certainly tend to popularize the market if stall holders would either announce the prices by word of mouth or have price tickets prominently displayed. The butcher stalls were taking advantage of the half-holiday at the ordinary stores by charging excessive prices, yet this circumstance did not prevent them doing a brisk business. The general cleanliness of the meat stalls did not compare favorably with the stores throughout the city. The meat was not under cover of any sort and flies were to be observed enjoying themselves on the exposed joints of meat. This is a matter which should claim the attention of the authorities, for fly-blown meat is a danger to the community.

However, taken as a whole, the market seemed deservedly popular. Most of the stalls were attractively decorated for the occasion and in most cases the prices compared favorably with those charged outside. The amount of business being transacted is proof that at least a certain section of the public is well satisfied with its treatment, and it would be a mistake to condemn the many for the shortcomings of the few. If the butchers were compelled to close their stalls at 1 p.m. and thus be placed on a par with the shops, competition would force the former to offer as good value in goods and service as is offered elsewhere. It is the position of special privilege which the meat sellers at the market now occupy which enables them to more than hold their own.

Loonger.

THE OLD GUARD

What the Veterans Are Doing in the Army
(By One of Them)

Wherever one goes in these days the sight of khaki has become so commonplace, and men in uniform look so much alike, that one is liable to take little notice of the man beneath the peaked cap, but to understand the British Army of today it is well worth while to look beyond the buttons and badge. Here at this railway station we see a boy, he cannot be more than fifteen, yet he wears a corporal's stripe. He is a member of his school O.T.C., proud to be permitted to wear the King's uniform and prouder still of the roll of honor that hangs in his school armory, of men who have learnt much on the very playing-field where he is studying the rudiments of soldiering.

And then our eyes wander to the man standing a yard or two away. He also is in khaki, but what a contrast! His face is rugged and tanned, his hair grey, his knees (it may be confessed) not quite as straight as 20 years ago; and yet there is that about his bearing that denotes the unexplainable something we call "soldierly," and his medal ribbons are four; why are we so ignorant of our country's deeds that we can only recognize two of them, those of the South African War?

Again we glance out of the window and this time we notice a sergeant talking to a middle-aged lieutenant wearing a green and yellow ribbon. Who are these veterans, what are they doing and why are they doing it? Little does it matter where you may travel in Great Britain, you will run across these veterans, all doing their bit and in this body of men, all over-military age, we may learn much of the spirit that is leading the way to victory over the Central Powers of Europe.

"Why are they doing it?" Surely these men of many campaigns could truly say, "We have done our share, we are over age, let the youngsters carry on." The simplest way to answer our question is to get into conversation with one of them, but even this is not so simple as it appears, for the man we choose does not hide his suspicion that we are after no good, but after a while, when he is satisfied that it is himself we are interested in and nothing else, we find him a most agreeable companion.

"It's a funny thing," he begins, "but the first time we paraded as a battalion, I mean the 1st West — National Reserve, was August 4th, 1914, a date England is not likely to forget. We had our colors given to us that day, subscribed for by the ladies of the country, blessed by his Lordship the Bishop of —, and presented by Mrs. —, the M.P.'s wife. Yes, sir, it was a grand sight, some 1,500 of us on parade and 70 per cent wearing medals. There were all sorts old navy men, guardsmen,

gunners, territorials, volunteers, and, in fact, representatives of every branch of either service, and every one had served his time and knew what soldiering meant. When we heard that war had been declared there was hardly one of the younger men of that 1,500 who did not volunteer for service. I know one officer, he was just forty and had been machine-gun officer in a territorial brigade, who volunteered twice in a week and I hear he was five years younger the second time than he was the first (at least, according to his papers) and then, still being refused, he offered himself as machine gun instructor. He's with us now, and is still hoping to get abroad before the war is over.

"After that things seemed to get a bit slack as far as the N. R. was concerned till October, when we got word that a company was to be formed for active service. I don't know whether the authorities had any doubts as to their ability to raise a whole company or how many volunteered for it. All I know is they have raised twelve such companies now, and could if required raise more.

"You ought to have seen us mobilize. It was an inspiring sight, a hundred and ten of us and three officers, and the officers the only ones in uniform, but it had its humorous side, too. Can't you imagine the feeling of a town councillor, an ex-volunteer private of some gentleman's corps, finding himself standing-at-ease next to a scavenger of his town, an ex-militia man! We mobilized on October 14th and had our first day's training on the 15th. Oh, that first ten minutes! A right turn was done in every conceivable way that had been laid down by drill instructors for the last thirty years, but at the end of a week we could move a company, and in exactly a fortnight we were sent to protect lines of communication.

"I've been out two years now and am ready for another two years, if necessary. The first winter we were out was the worst; day after day, week after week, and month after month it was rain, rain, rain, but the most surprising thing about it is that not one of us went sick, and considering we are all used to home life, I should think it is something to be proud of, when you consider we are out all night sometimes in most exposed places and in all weather. But we don't have time to think of our ailments as we used to, so we just make a joke of the elements and remember that the youngsters are having a worst time out yonder. One portly old private in my company, when he came in to the guard-room last winter looking for all the world like a snow-man, remarked that if he and Sergeant — could share the same thermometer they would both be happier. Sergeant — was his youngest son, who is serving in Africa.

"Why did we come out, sir? Yes, you are quite right, we all did our bit years ago but you don't think we old soldiers were going to take the Kaiser lying down, did you, and we

mostly have wives and daughters and you don't think we are going to let the Boches come over to England and treat them as they did the Belgian women, now did you? No, sir, there ain't one of us could stand it, and we were all determined to do our bit. We sometimes feel a bit ashamed we are not in more dangerous places, but we know what our duty is, so we just use our common-sense and obey orders and we don't mean to come out of uniform till the war's over, not if we can help it."

At this point I saw the branch train, for which I was waiting, signalled, so I ventured to ask my new friend if he and his comrades never got "fed up" and indulged in grousing.

"Yes, sir," he said without hesitation, "we do sometimes get fed up, and then of course we grouse, but it's always to the same tune! Why can't they send us across?" Of course we know we should not be much good in the trenches, but we want somehow to get in the thick of it and I hope we shall before it's all over. It's that thought that bucks us up when we get moody, but we are proud of the fact that men and munitions have never been stopped from getting to the Front through any of them spies that may be about. This is your train, sir. Let's put your bag in for you."

Then as we noisily moved out of the station, I received one of the smartest salutes I have seen since I left the service and began to wonder if my veteran had recognized in me a veteran of the seventies.

MOTHER, MINE

Inspired by a Young Soldier and His Mother

When I look into your eyes,
Mother mine,
All the base and worldly dies,
The Divine
In the depths of me that lies,
Seems to shine.

When I clasp you to my heart,
Mother mine,
All the true in life and art
All the fine,
Seems of thee to be a part,
Seems all thine.

When I stroke your silvered hair,
Mother mine,
Mystic light beyond compare
Doth refine
All the world and make it fair,
Nay, sublime!

J. WOODWARD.

MUSICAL GOSSIP

Handel and Herschel

Dr. Edward Miller (composer of the famous hymn tune "Rockingham"), who was once a member of Handel's orchestra, used to tell the following story:

"About the year 1753 a minor canon of Gloucester Cathedral offered his services as a singer, which Handel accepted, and he was employed in the chorus. Not satisfied with this department, Handel acceded to the canon's request that he should sing a solo, so that his voice should appear to better advantage. But he sang so badly that the audience violently hissed him. When the performance was over, by way of consolation, Handel made him the following speech: 'I am sorry, very sorry for you indeed, my dear sir; but go back to your church in the country. God will forgive you for your bad singing; these wicked people in London, dey will not forgive you.'

Also the following concerning the appointment of an organist to the Halifax (Yorkshire) parish church.

"About this time (1760) a new organ was built by Snetzler for Halifax Parish Church. Mr. Herschel and six others were candidates for the organist's place, and they drew lots how they were to perform in rotation. My friend Herschel drew the third lot — the second performer was Mr. (afterwards Dr.) Wainwright, of Manchester, whose finger was so rapid that old Snetzler ran about the church exclaiming, 'Te tevel, te tevel! he run over the key like one cat; he vil not give my piphes room for to speak.' During Mr. Wainwright's performance I was standing in the middle aisle with Herschel. 'What chance have you,' I asked, 'to follow this man?' He replied, 'I don't know; I am sure my fingers will not do.' On which he ascended the organ loft, and produced from the organ such a full volume of slow, solemn harmony, as I could by no means account for. After a short extempore effusion of this character, he finished with the "Old Hundredth" tune, which he played better than his opponent had done. 'Aye, aye,' cried Snetzler, 'tish is very goot, very goot indeed; I vil luf tish man, for he gives my piphes room for to speak.' On my asking Herschel by what means he produced so uncommon an effect, he replied, 'I told you my fingers would not do it,' and, producing two pieces of lead from his waistcoat pocket, he said,

'One of these I placed on the lowest key of the organ, and the other on the octave above; thus, by accommodating the harmony, I produced the effect of four hands instead of two.' Of course, those were pre-pedal days, so far as English organs were concerned.

This resourcefulness was characteristic of the man and helped him to achieve the great fame, which afterwards came to him as an astronomer. The nimble fingered Wainwright will ever be remembered by his tune "Yorkshire," which he composed for Byron's "Christians, Awake."

—H. J. P.

MUNICIPAL COMMENT

The Johnson Street Bridge

It is authoritatively stated that the C. P. R. has made a proposition to the city and to the Government as a temporary settlement of the bridge question. The company proposes to give the city the old bridge, and that the corporation move it to Yates Street, and that the company be allowed to bring its steel bridge that has done service in two places already, and re-erect it where the present bridge stands. It is stated that this arrangement be maintained till the city and Province are financially able to go ahead with the original project. Such a subterfuge is too plain to mislead anyone. The Railway Company see it is beaten in every way on this bridge matter. The Hon. John Oliver has risen to the occasion and has very properly and firmly protected the Government's and the city's rights. The Hon. Minister put the case so strongly and so clearly that there was no mistaking where the Railway Commission stood. The Monocle would advise the Hon. Mr. Oliver to stand by the position he has already won. The people are behind him. Why the Mayor expressed himself favorably to this deal the Monocle fails to understand. The Mayor earned just praise from citizens for the way he handled the original bridge agreement. It is pretty well established that the city has traffic rights on the present bridge. The railway thinks so or it would not have collapsed so easily. It is due the citizens for the Mayor to explain why he favors this temporary deal. Has he reckoned the cost to the city in not only moving this structure but in maintaining it as well? No, No, Mr. Mayor, the company is over a barrel. Make them come through.

ESTATE OF JAMES NOTMAN, Deceased

ALL persons having claims against the Estate of James Notman, late of Victoria, B.C., contractor, are required to send particulars thereof, duly verified, to the undersigned, not later than the 15th day of July, 1917, after which date the undersigned administrator will proceed to distribute the assets of the deceased among the parties entitled thereto, having regard only to the claims of which he shall then have notice.

Dated this 5th day of June, 1917.
ERNEST LYALL TAIT,
Administrator of the Estate of James Notman, deceased, 2014 Floor, B. C. Permanent Loan Bldg., Victoria, B.C.
July 7-28

LAND ACT

Form No. 11
Form of Notice
Renfrew Land District, District of Victoria.

TAKE NOTICE that The Lummi Bay Packing Co., Ltd., of 602 Pacific Building, Vancouver, B.C., and Sawmill Operators, intends to apply for permission to lease the following described foreshore lands covered at high water level.

Commencing at a post planted the southwest corner of lot 528, thence true north a distance of 1200 feet, more or less, to high water mark on the eastern shore of Nitinat Lake, thence southeasterly and southwesterly following the said high water mark of the said Nitinat Lake to the point of commencement and containing 6 acres more or less.

The Lummi Bay Packing Co., Ltd.,
P. A. DEVEREUX, B.C.L.S., Agent,
July 7

WATER NOTICE

Use and Storage

TAKE NOTICE that The Lummi Bay Packing Co., Ltd., whose address is 602 Pacific Building, Vancouver, will apply for a licence to take and use (all the water), 84 acre feet, and to store 84 acre feet of water out of Wy-al Creek and Lake, which flows westerly and drains into Nitinat Lake, about 500 feet north-east of the southwest corner of lot 528, Renfrew District.

The storage-dam will be located at about 1,500 feet westerly from the outlet of Wy-al Lake. The capacity of the reservoir to be created is about 20 ac. 84 acre feet, and it will flood about 13 acres of land. The water will be diverted from the stream at a point about 1,600 feet east of the southwest corner of lot 528, and will be used for Class A Domestic (Steamers). Miscellaneous purpose upon the land, described as lot No. 528.

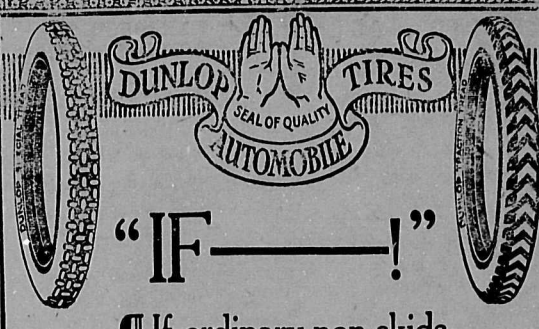
This notice was posted on the ground on the 4th day of June, 1917.
A copy of this notice and an application pursuant thereto and to the "Water Act, 1914," will be filed in the office of the Water Recorder at Victoria.
Objections to the application may be filed with the said Water Recorder or with the Comptroller of Water Rights, Parliament Buildings, Victoria, B. C., within thirty days after the first appearance of this notice in a local newspaper.

The Lummi Bay Packing Co., Ltd.,
P. A. DEVEREUX, B.C.L.S., Agent,
The date of the first publication of this notice is June 16th, 1917.
July 7-28.

NOTICE

TAKE NOTICE that Popham Bros., Ltd., intends, at the expiration of one month from the first publication of this notice, to apply to the Registrar of Joint Stock Companies to approve its change of name from Popham Bros., Ltd., to "Ormond's, Ltd."

Dated at Victoria, B.C., this 5th day of June, 1917.
GEO. A. MORPHY,
Solicitor for Popham Bros., Ltd.



"IF ———!"

¶ If ordinary non-skids could answer for those many miles you expect to go after the first thousand there would have been no success for "Dunlop Traction Tread" or "Dunlop Special."

A. 76

Phone 2190

Dunlop Tire & Rubber Goods Co.,
Limited

853 Yates St., - Victoria

White Lunch Rooms

642 Yates Street, 1009 Government Street
556 Johnson Street

Best of Food and Service

Economical, Absolutely Sanitary

Collegiate School

PHONE 62
1157 Rockland Avenue, Victoria, B. C.

Private Day and Boarding School For Boys

SMALL CLASSES—INDIVIDUAL ATTENTION

Summer Term Commences Monday, April 23rd

PRINCIPAL - - - A. D. MUSKETT, ESQ.

For Prospectus, giving full particulars, apply to the Principal

THE PLEASURE OF TRAVEL

is fully realized in travelling on the lines of the Canadian Pacific Railway. By its lines can be reached all points in Canada and the United States.

It operates its own Sleeping and Dining Cars, and has its own Hotels and Steamships. Its magnificent Mountain Scenery and the excellence of the Dining Car Service have made the favorite route for tourists across the American Continent.

For Sleeping Car and Steamship reservations and any further information write or call on

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1102 Government Street Victoria B. C.

B. C. FUNERAL CO.

(Hayward's, Ltd.)

734 Broughton Street Victoria, B. C.

Established 1867

When necessity requires you to have the services of an embalmer or funeral conductor

Phone 2235, 2236, 2237 or 2238

and experienced assistants will respond to your call at any hour. Our modern Chapel and Private Parlours are at your disposal.

CHAS. HAYWARD, President REGINALD HAYWARD, Secretary

FREDERICK CASELTON, Manager

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are famous for their flavour and their freshness

PUBLIC MARKET

STALL 9

NEW METHOD LAUNDRY

LIMITED

"QUALITY LAUNDERERS"

1015-1017 North Park Street
Phone 2300.

SOTTO VOCE

BY THE HORNET

That the Confederation celebration in Parliament Square was a great success.

That the collective offering of the Lord's prayer was due to an inspiration of Rev. Wm. Stevenson.

That it probably saved a long dispute among the clergy on the all important point of precedence.

That Victoria can muster more silk hats at short notice than any other city on the continent.

That the only notable who refused to don a "topper" was Hon. John Oliver.

That Honest John lost no respect for clinging to his rigid and rugged simplicity.

That John has never claimed to be a courtier and has no ambitions in that direction.

That he is more concerned to get the Province out of the slough of despond.

That he continues to fearlessly do his duty as he sees it.

That Confederation-day picnic parties at Beacon Hill unwittingly destroyed a fine crop of hay.

That the civic fathers should have reaped the crop during the latter part of June.

That the hay destroyed was worth many hundreds of dollars.

That it would have gone a long way towards eliminating the hay bills for city teams during the coming winter.

That a school of whales were observed to rise to the surface off Beacon Hill last Monday.

That as soon as they discovered the proximity of Victoria, "The Whale City," they fled for their lives.

That the Canadian Freedom League, with headquarters in this city, has been reported by a local "loyalist" for spreading sedition.

That the authorities are now considering what action, if any, they should take in the matter.

That it is difficult to do anything in the case of an organization which carefully keeps within the law.

That according to Rev. J. G. Inster, the anti-conscription movement has attained enormous proportions back East.

That the City Council has had a number of secret meetings of late.

That a scheme for buying the plant of the B. C. Electric is one subject under discussion.

That the Johnson-cum-Herald-cum-Yates Street Bridge is another burning question of the hour.

That the demand by civic workmen for a living wage is still another thorny problem.

That the name of "J. S. H. Matson" no longer appears at the head of the editorial page of The Colonist.

That no announcement has been made re The Colonist's internal changes.

That the Vancouver Sun and The News-Advertiser are about to amalgamate.

That J. S. H. Matson will cease connection with the News-Advertiser also.

That "Sam" is no longer the uncrowned king of British Columbia.

That a few years ago he exercised more influence over the destinies of the Government and people of British Columbia than any other man.

That despite his admitted faults, "Sam" has been a kindly employer of labor and has won the regard of all his colleagues in the newspaper business.

THROUGH THE WOMEN'S WINDOW

The click of the knitting needles are heard wherever women congregate these days; at the afternoon teas, in the theatres and on the street cars the knitting goes on diligently.

The ceaseless evolution of the knitting needles recall stories of the French Revolution and of Dickens' graphic description of that period of the world's history. His words are so aptly suited to the period just before this world-war that I hope to be excused for quoting.

"It was the best of times, the worst of times, it was the age of wisdom, it was the age of foolishness, it was the age of belief, it was the epoch of incredulity, it was the season of Light, it was the season of Darkness, it was the spring of hope, it was the winter of despair, we had everything before us, we had nothing before us, we were all going direct to Heaven, we were all going direct the other way—in short the period was so much like the present period that some of the noisiest authorities insisted on its being received for good or evil in the superlative degree of comparison."

When Dickens wrote this descriptive analysis he tells us that it applied not only to the period of the French Revolution, but to the days in which he then lived, 1850. Today they are as equally applicable to this period of the world's history as they were to the earlier and cruder civilizations centuries ago.

Before this world-war we had begun to think we were nearing the golden age again. The human race imagined that they had climbed out of the valley and had reached the mountain tops, but pride often goes before a fall, for our vaunted civilization has tumbled about our ears like the tower of Babel.

We seem to have gone back to the very beginning of things where "Jehovah repented that He had made man on the earth because all the imagination and thoughts of his heart were evil, and Jehovah said I will destroy man whom I have created from the face of the earth for I repenteth me that I have made him."

That same process of destruction has been going on for ages during the evolution of the human race, but man has not yet assimilated the lesson of life. He still goes on treading the same old path, heedless of the lesson the past would teach: he continues to make the same old blunders, filled with the same old ambitions, the age-old desires, the same lust for conquest, which things have always brought the same old punishment and result—disaster and retrogression: Men assiduously and patriotically destroying human life, women humbly and diligently attempting to carry on, to build up, to succor the life that remains to us. Swords and knitting needles, instruments of destruction and construction, strange combination but with a peculiar affinity for each other.

Will history always go on repeating itself, world without end? Must men fight and women weep and submissively give the fruit of their bodies to be targets for guns? How long, O Lord, shall the human race tread the path of destruction? Just as long as masses continue to learn the science of warfare and are willing to be sacrificed for a mistaken ideal.

Swords will never be beat into plowshares while the mothers of men consent to war, and continue to think with men that a big army, a great navy and all the equipment of warfare is the only path to national greatness, the only way to build up a nation.

That is not the ideal that Christ set before us, and while we stick to that ideal of national greatness we will go round in a circle never making any advance towards the promised land, the Kingdom of God on earth. Through such methods of advancing civilization we can never attain to our divine heritage, children of God and joint heirs with Jesus Christ.

"Seek ye first the Kingdom of God and His righteousness and all things are yours," said Jesus. Where are we to find a nation which seeks these things first of all?

In every nation where thrones are set up there is a scramble for the biggest navy, the biggest army, the largest Empire and all the pomp of military honor and power.

We shout boastfully that Britannia rules the waves, then we say that Germany is not humble enough and we must teach her a lesson in true humility.

Britains never shall be slaves! How we glory in that statement and imagine it is a truth. But are we not slaves, like the rest of humanity? Slaves to custom, slaves to money, to power?

We imagine we have a true democracy because our king is but a figurehead, and the people "rule," but the

masses are slaves to the "fuss and feathers" which surround a throne, a slavish reverence for hereditary nobility and all are in the scramble for "honors" and for "titles."

Successful wars have always created a boom in honors and in titles and class distinction gets a firmer hold upon the necks of the people.

Class distinction was the curse of barbarism, and is still the curse of civilization, and a hindrance to true progress. The Socialist dimly realizes this truth and is striving in his own way to find the remedy, but they forget the key to the situation.

God shall be King over all the earth—that is the great lesson the past would teach and that humanity must learn before permanent peace can be established. When that realization comes to humanity, all earthly thrones will totter, and the brotherhood of men and of nations will not be far off.

ALICE M. CHRISTIE.

LETTERS TO PROMINENT MEN

WILLIAM HOHENZOLLERN

To the Kaiser:—

I never had an introduction to you, and to speak the truth right out, I don't want to have one. You are a most undesirable acquaintance. There's nothing about you that I like. Your crown, your person, your opinions, your religion, your country, your armies, your navy, your wealth, your language or your manners. Fact is, I dislike you through and through.

I am of the opinion that you are rather unpopular just now in Canada. Your stock is a bit low in this country. Depressed, as you may say. If you don't believe me, come over and see. If you come over in an empty lager-beer barrel, I should advise you to label the same:

THIS SIDE UP WITH CARE.

Let me know the date of your arrival in Victoria and I'll meet you sure. There will be no brass band in attendance. If it gets known you will have a reception such as never was. The papers will give you all the publicity you will ever want in this world. I'll hire the largest hall in Victoria for you to lecture in, and sell the seats by auction. Between ourselves, I consider that after paying transportation expenses and the cost of the beer-barrel, and a few trifling etceteras, I shall be fixed for life. So will you when the crowd get through with you. Your experience will be unique. Lese Majestie will sure be in evidence. There will be less majesty than you ever dreamt of.

Just now I would rather hear you lecture than Premier Brewster or Mayor Todd. They may be good talkers, but they can't draw the crowd like you could. I'll divide the gate at 50/50 with you, if you'll come. Strictly on the Q.T., you will never go. At least not the way of the beer-barrel. I have a notion that some of the folks would be a little rough on you at the start.

There are a few Belgians in the city that say unpleasant things about you. They call you a barbarous beast, a vile assassin, a crowned murderer and a hellish despot. I do not. I only thing those sort of things and a lot worse, but I keep it quiet, for fear of offending the ladies.

Which reminds me that some of the female sex sometimes make unkind statements about you. You see, some of them were friends of Edith Cavell and Captain Frye, and they would much like to hear your views about their murders. After hearing you, I am inclined to the view that there would be something doing. What it might be need not now be discussed. My frank opinion is that the sheriff would not be required. He could take a holiday, and get ready for the next.

I don't like the way you mix up religion with war. You seem to think that there is a Deity somewhere that approves of the vile business you are engaged in. That is why you take him into your confidence and ask him to bless the murderous engines and machinery of destruction. I suppose you offered a special thanksgiving for the school children in London your aviators murdered, but I don't think that St. Peter passed in the message. Perhaps you marked it "collect," and he knew your credit was not good on the other side. Keep out of the business of mixing up religion with murder. You are as bad as some of our parsons over here. Lots of them have only got nine commandments now. They have cut out "Thou shalt not kill," because they say it is unsuitable nowadays. The Higher Critics don't like it, either. I prefer the old-fashioned religion myself, which a good Teacher used to teach in old Jerusalem. The same place where your beloved Turks are in the murdering business, or nearby. Folks say that they are a wee bit unfriendly to the Armenians, but perhaps this is

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These suits are part of our regular stock—values that sell regularly at prices to \$22.50. But after a busy season's selling, we have sorted them out as surplus sizes and models of which we have but one or two patterns of a kind. Each suit is perfectly tailored and finished in fashionable styles. Two and three button models, suitable for the young man or for the more conservative dresser. All sizes are represented, but not in each different pattern. Your choice from a wide range of shades and patterns, in serviceable tweeds and mixtures. The man who requires a better grade suit for less—and what man doesn't?—has a rare opportunity at this sale. Early shopping advisable. —Men's Clothing, Main Floor.

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Suits of fine quality tweeds and mixtures, smartly tailored in double breasted and Norfolk models. All splendid quality fabrics, and some of our smartest shades and patterns included. Suits that were formerly priced to \$10.00, now grouped into this one low-priced offering for a quick disposal. A SUIT, \$6.95. —Boys' Clothing, Main Floor

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only slander. Many good men suffer from libellous statements. Nero did, and Herod also. Likewise yourself. Neither of you three would be classed as saints, but in my private opinion you stand the highest of the three. That is why you are called the "All-Highest." If you dispute the point, call in Satan to arbitrate, and I'll stand ice drinks for both of you, if you lose the decision.

When our boys march to Berlin, I fancy they may want to take you to a show in London. Don't consent before you take the trip to Victoria. It will spoil the business here. If they sort of INSIST, ask to be tried by your Peers. Tell them that Magna Charta demands it. You ought to get a fair trial from folks in your own station in life. I would rather not say where the trial would take place, but I think the presiding judge would not wear a wig or be clothed in ermine. He would probably be adorned with horns and hoofs and the atmosphere might be a little torrid. As a friend, he might let you down easy, and give you a job in the dry as Chief Shoveller. Coal and sulphur are pretty cheap in those regions and the pay is very certain. You will not get more than you have earned or deserved.

Believe me to be,
Dear Fritz,
Yours etcetera,
JOHN CANUCK.

If a man tells us what he thinks of his neighbors, we can generally tell what his neighbors think of him.

War-Time Rations

"You seem to be late this morning."
"Yes; I was coming through the park on my motor-bike, and when I wasn't looking a squirrel sneaked up and chewed the nuts off it."

Evidently It Was

The old day an excited individual accosted a street gamin with the question, "I say, lad, which is the quickest way for me to get to the railway station?"
"Run, sir," was the response.

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